

Rep. Tom Emmer on The Brian Kilmeade Show

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****HOST:**

** And with me in the studio is Majority Whip Congressman Tom Emmer, out of Minnesota. Great to see you, Congressman. I see you've got a bad ankle, a bad Achilles, but you're playing hard.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Hey, we'll be fine. I am a one-legged man in a kicking contest right now, but we're winning.

****HOST:**

** Right, yeah, absolutely. So for example, I think the thing that comes to mind now is what a great job the Vice President's doing cracking down on fraud. I think 16 have been arrested in Minnesota.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah, that was just last week. There were 15, and this one is separate from the Feeding Our Future scandal, which is 250 million, largest pandemic fraud case in the country. This is now health care fraud, Brian. It's 90 million in health care fraud. They defrauded, took money away from the disabled, from elderly, I mean children, and it's pathetic.

****HOST:**

** Yeah, congratulations to the Vice President. He's doing an amazing job, and really got to commend President Trump for unleashing the task force, a strike task force on Minnesota. See, the other thing that's interesting is they're getting the money back. In his press conference yesterday, he said, I'm bringing this money back and putting it back into the Treasury. And the thing is, it stuck out with me, that when Stephen Miller said, when these programs were put out there for people, whether it's food stamps or Medicaid, Medicare, it was kind of a mutual trust thing. You say you need the money, we'll give it to you. But the follow-up, there was no follow-up because that bond was broken. And in fact, people took advantage of it, especially during the pandemic.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, they've been taking advantage of it forever. And we've known that there are these state-run scams, right? They charge the federal government back for more than they actually incur, so they get more federal funds on some of these programs. But this is a lot more egregious than just playing on the edges, Brian. These people were making millions, and in some cases, billions off of the American taxpayer. And that is just wrong, and it's time that it ended. Thank God for President Trump.

****HOST:**

** Did you hear about this when Walz was being vetted for vice president?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Not from them, but I'll tell you what, we've been writing letters and trying to sound the alarm on this since at least 2017. In fact, when Donald Trump tweeted out that Friday night, Somali fraudsters, and he got attacked for the, it's racist, it's whatever. Guess what? I thanked him, because what he did was he finally got the press interested in this, which is a national story now. Without him doing that, we probably would still be fighting this uphill. And now people are starting to see just how serious it is.

****HOST:**

** So here's what the vice president said yesterday, cut 56. We've referred over \$22 billion in fraudulent small business loans back to the Treasury for collection. We deferred more than \$1.3 billion in fraudulent Medicaid reimbursements that were coming from various states, particularly California. We put a six month hold on enrollments for new hospice and home healthcare providers because so many of the newer hospice providers were not actually providing hospice services, but were just focused on fraud. So we're gonna cut that out for a little bit and try to get to a place where we can actually certify that the people providing hospice services are actually providing those very necessary and important services.

****HOST:**

** Yeah, I mean, because they can't verify it. I mean, can you imagine this, taking child programs, autism in your state, and autistic specifically, I'm sure it's other places. And then hospice care. So the last lap of life, you have a bunch of empty hulks of buildings with no one's there, and there was a hospice on basically every corner.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, I think you're still just scratching the tip of the iceberg. He's talking about billions across the country. You talked about my state, there was autism center fraud, there's daycare fraud. I mean, literally where one Somali fraudster would allege that they have your kids in their daycare, your kids aren't in their daycare, and they collect money for them. And by the way, you apparently have their kids and you're defrauding the government. But the Medicaid program, they had a housing stabilization fund, which is supposed to cost a couple million bucks when they started it five years ago. They shut it down last October, because it was like 400 million had been built out of that system. This was housing stabilization for homeless at all. This goes way beyond what we've even seen so far, as far as I'm concerned.

****HOST:**

** So we're seeing that now in New York, because I'm sure you can't follow it with everything going on. But Mayor Mondani yesterday basically says, the landlords are the problem, okay, really landlords are the problem. So we're gonna freeze rent. And for those who can't do it, if they can't make it, we will have the city take over those buildings. In the big picture, Congressman, isn't that the goal? If they are too socialist, they wanna take these buildings over. They wanna rent them to people or give them away towards taxpayer dollars to subsidize them. That's done in the past, just going back to 70s, 80s, and 90s. All this stuff goes into disrepair, becomes a haven for crime, because government can't run this stuff.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** This is the projects, is what they do. When they subsidize this stuff and people don't have an ownership interest, you're right, Brian, then you don't take care of it. In this case, your mayor is reflective of a small slice of our population, but a very loud slice of the population that we need to be listening to. They need to be reminded what made this country great. By the way, St. Paul, Minnesota, I think, passed a rent control. And within months, after the local news was celebrating this big movement, within months they started reporting, you know what? These projects are stopping. The contractors are not moving forward. You will find it's not just that these

buildings will go into disrepair and they'll become just cesspools. But you will lose new opportunities, new buildings, because people are going to want to invest if Mayor Mamdani, the commie, is going to take over their project.

****HOST:**

** Right. And the thing is, too, it's just blaming landlords and you're subsidizing the buildings. And then you build these supermarkets. Isn't that great? Three supermarkets subsidized by the city. Well, that's taxpayer dollars. And then you turn around and say, well, where are you getting the taxes? I got to raise them. Who are you going to raise them on? The rich people. Oh, the ones you vilified? Because they're leaving. They are leaving. So if I can play this out, and I'm not an economist, when you sit down in those doors closed and you do this all the time, budget meetings, there's things you say on camera. Not you, but people say on camera and then they get in the room, the door closed and go, how do we balance this budget? Why are they getting behind closed doors and still not understanding that their budget's not going to balance?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Because it's your money and mine, Brian. They don't care. They're going to spend whatever they've got and they're going to take more. Remember, I think it was your state, New York, that was one of the first to do the millionaire's tax under the elder Cuomo when he was governor. I think it lasted like 10 years. Somebody should go check it. But they found that most of that money moved to New Jersey and they let it expire after that. Now it's all moving to Miami and Boca and all kinds of places in Florida.

****HOST:**

** So here is Mondami talking about Bezos. I like the fact. A lot of times, and I wouldn't know what this is like, but billionaires, and I think Musk is going to be the first trillionaire, they don't want to say, I'm a billionaire, you know, because it's vilified these days. Ken Griffin's a billionaire a million times over, but he puts hundreds of millions of dollars into charity too. You hire 9,000 people. They got to get apartments. They go out to dinner. They have kids. They're going to go into sports. The ripple effect on down. So you last so far you have a situation where Bezos sat down last week on CNBC to talk about how ridiculous this vilification is. And Mondami answered yesterday cut 37. I know a few teachers in Queens who would beg to differ. And I think that if I was worth as much money as he was, that I would probably say the same thing. The fact of the matter is that we are talking about a city where one in four New Yorkers are living in poverty. And we're hearing from one of the richest men that our world has ever seen about how he and others who make that kind of money shouldn't have to pay their fair share. And frankly, what New Yorkers want to see is a tax system that recognizes the scale of this affordability crisis and actually provides a way for city government to be able to invest in those same New Yorkers in the manner that we used to decades ago.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Their share a fair share and investment. These are buzzwords of the far left. They want to invest your money. Remember, if anybody wants to know how this really works, go and find a book that everybody should have read at least as early as their freshman year of college called The Road to Serfdom, written by an economist named Hayek back during World War II. He ran it to his elitist. He wrote it for his elitist buddies. He was an Austrian economist who was exiled to Great Britain during the war, and he wrote it to his Marxist, communist, socialist friends who believe that the state, and this is Mondami, that the state can distribute scarce resources better than human effort, right? The idea was you have a central authority that will decide where all these resources go as opposed to people with their own hard work and talents making that happen. The free hand that Adam Smith talks about, and guess what? It works as long as you're part of that central group making the

decisions. When you're not, then you're in trouble.

****HOST:**

** Majority Whip Tom Emmer, our guest, and Congressman, when you look at a situation where you have the top 1% paying, I think, 40% of the taxes, top 10% paying 60 to 70% of the taxes. I saw, I think it was Marc Andreessen yesterday with Joe Rogan, said that he's paying 60%. So for every \$10 you make, you give away six. That's what Europe did with the whole wealth tax. Could you describe for our audience how damaging the wealth tax is? On the surface, you might go, okay, what's 1% more? What's the big deal? Why so many wealthy are making sure they're not in a state that has a wealth tax and they're running out of California even before the referendum goes in?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Because they can. I mean, this is why. If you've got the resources, money will go to where it's going to be treated most fairly under any circumstance. And by the way, there's a book, about a 200-page book, called The Myths of Inequality. Do you know that in this country, it is the US Census Bureau that defines wealth and poverty? They define wealth in this country as pre-tax income. They define poverty as pre-government transfer income. They then divide us up into quintiles in this book. They show you that a very small slice is the richest of the rich, but they include a huge number to pull up other people into that top quintile. In the bottom quintile, they show you this, that if you are making pre-government transfer income of, say, \$4,000, \$4,500 this year, and you qualify for every government program that's out there, you will actually be taking home between \$40,000 and \$45,000, which will put you in the bottom end of the third quintile with people who are double incomes, husbands, wives, working their tails off just to make ends meet. There's your problem.

****HOST:**

** So here's the thing. When you have investors and they have stocks, so they hold NVIDIA, let's say the top five, they want to have unrealized taxes on unrealized gains. So I didn't cash in, you and I, let's say we're lucky enough to hold those big five stocks in meta, and we had a good year, right? They want to tax on that year. Now even though you haven't cashed out on that, you haven't even maybe take dividends on that cash, and then if it's a bad year, you don't get any money back. So what are your thoughts about that?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, you remember the cartoon Popeye where the guy would say, I'll gladly pay you on Tuesday for a hamburger today. Well, now our government is saying, I'll gladly give you your hard-earned gain after you pay today. I mean, literally, they're saying, you give us the money before you earn anything. That's like completely, forgive me, but it's a scientific term. That's back ass backwards. I understand it.

****HOST:**

** So just looking at your fortunes, you did Every Seed Matters. I think most people think between, what do you say, 15 and 20 seats up for grabs. Do you see more than that? Do you think it's 30?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, there are over 20 Democrats who won by five points or less in the last presidential election. So those would be considered swing seats of that, but realistically, I think you're in the ballpark. 20 to 25.

****HOST:**

** So if you look at that, knowing yesterday, it looks as though South Carolina says, we're not going to get rid of the one seat, so the Clyburn seat stands for the midterms. And I believe Alabama, the same thing, you're not going to get that extra seat. But you did have big gains. It looks like Florida will stand, just as my people tell me about the courts. We know Virginia was halted, so that's not going to happen. And we know Texas was sustained and Louisiana was still waiting. But it looks like Louisiana. So your thoughts about holding the house with gas up so high and an unpopular war going on right now, somewhat in hyperspace?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah, well, the first it is going to be about the economy. Affordability is a made up term. It is another term for the economy. One Democrat commentator years ago said it's about the economy, stupid. It will be again when we get to next fall, but we've never lost an election in May. The economy right now is doing better than people even know. The focus has been on gas prices. We still have a lot of people traveling on Memorial Day. It's a big deal, right? I mean, most people that will decide this election are trying to pay a mortgage, put food on the table, clothes on the kids. They're thinking about the family vacation they're going to take this summer. And if it's at \$4.50 to \$6 a gallon, it's going to affect what they do. It'll be the end of the summer, though, when hopefully this all comes together. And I like our chances, Brian. After redistricting, we've got a two to one advantage. We've got ten new seats. They've got five. Four of those are in California. They've got one of our seats, California 22, David Valadao, that is a Trump plus 1.7. That is a swing seat. We've got five of theirs. I like our chances. It's about the economy. If the president concludes this thing, things start to settle down. So people can focus on the good news that's in the economy and you start to see gas prices come down, which they will. I like our chances.

****HOST:**

** So I mean, but if you talk to do Democrats have as much confidence behind the scenes as they have in front of the camera? King Jeffrey's basically is fitting himself for the gavel every day. The man's never going to be the leader. He's not a leader. They are deluded. Ask yourself, who is the Democrats leader nationally? They don't have one. Is it Tim Walz? Absolutely not. He's got to go to Spain now to get somebody to listen to him. And what is their what is their message? They don't have one other than we hate Trump, right? It doesn't work.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah, I don't I don't know what they would do different. I mean, they are talking about raising taxes, which is usually not a popular thing to do. Well, just go to Virginia, where you now have Tim Walz and address in the governor's office. Abigail Spanberger. That is what they will do to this country if you let them run it. But unlike what's happened with Plattner and what's happening with Mamdani and the Seattle mayor, they said they were socialists. The scary thing with her, she said she was a moderate. So that's what I find really worrisome as an American majority with Tom Emmer. Thanks so much for coming in.

****HOST:**

** All right. Thank you. Great to see it. Talk to you. I don't see any transcript segment provided in your message. You've included the instructions and identified the speakers (HOST and REP. TOM EMMER), but the actual transcript content appears to be missing. Could you please provide the transcript segment that needs speaker labels added? Once you share the text, I'll be happy to add the appropriate speaker labels while preserving all the original content exactly as specified.

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